

Vietnam's economy, logistical problems, or morale. Hence Washington knew almost nothing about the composition of imports, stock levels, or other key indices, and this made definitive judgments about the effectiveness of the bombing impossible.

TECHNOLOGY

LASER-GUIDED BOMBS

The laser-guided bomb (LGB), or “smart” bomb, was a first generation “precision-guided munition.” In Vietnam in 1972, these were available in two sizes: 2,000 lb (900 kg) and 3,000 lb (1360 kg). An aircraft equipped with an LGB could plant bombs within 20 feet (6 m) of the intended target, which was a massive improvement on the accuracy of fighter-bombers (500 feet/150 m) equipped with standard munitions.



2,000 LB PAVEWAY II LASER-GUIDED BOMB

» AFTER

Both US losses and damage to North Vietnam mounted as the bombing continued.

NEW EDGE

Special training for US naval air crews and **new weapons** for air forces improved American survivability and destructiveness and immediately put Washington in a stronger position for air warfare.

TALKS RESTART—AND STOP

The **peace talks in Paris** resumed in early November. However, although a draft agreement was reached, both North and South Vietnamese negotiators found cause to resist signing.